

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-II.3: Infinitives and Indirect Statement

Form the six ordinary infinitives and preserve subject, voice, and relative time in complementary and indirect-statement structures

A self-contained learning packet with a local reference card, enriched submodules, selected handwritten practice, a mastery record, and matching answers. This working study is not an official liturgical book or approved curriculum.

Corpus	1962 <i>Missale Romanum</i> ; Vulgate and ecclesiastical prose as supporting readers
Method	Print, annotate, parse, copy, transform, translate, and compose by hand
Pacing	Advance by demonstrated mastery; module packets use two focused sessions as a planning envelope
Document	Learning module; learner and terminal-key edition
Triptych: AI Driven Studies in Catholic Faith, Worship, and Law	

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Part I

Module Plan and Reference

CHAPTER 1

Plan, prerequisites, and advancement decision

Module ID	EL-II.3
Course stage	Stage II — Core Grammar
Prerequisites	EL-II.2 mastery: control comparison, adverbs, and operational numerals
Observable outcome	Form the six ordinary infinitives and preserve subject, voice, and relative time in complementary and indirect-statement structures
Printed practice	Worksheets II.9 (guided Variant A) and II.12 (independent Variant D), with terminal keys
Extension bank	Worksheets II.10 and II.11 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants
Next dependency	EL-II.4, Participles and the Ablative Absolute

1.1 Two focused sessions

Session 1 — guided acquisition. Build the infinitive voice/time axis and contrast complementary and indirect-statement minimal pairs, then complete Worksheet II.9 as the guided application.

Session 2 — transfer and gate. Analyze accusative subjects and predicate complements in context, convert direct to reported statements across time, and complete Worksheet II.12 independently.

The two-session plan is a workload envelope, not permission to advance by elapsed time. Stop, correct in a different color, and use an omitted variant when the mastery evidence below is absent.

Advance when: Form at least 90 percent of eighteen prompted infinitives, identify subject and relative time in ten unseen constructions with no more than one error, and convert three differently timed direct statements into accurate indirect statement.

CHAPTER 2

Module reference card

2.1 Terms, forms, and decisions to retrieve

- present, perfect, and future active and passive infinitives;
- time simultaneous with, prior to, or subsequent to the governing verb;
- complementary, subject, object, and indirect-statement infinitive roles; and
- accusative subject and accusative predicate complement in indirect statement.

2.2 High-risk contrast

A complementary infinitive completes another verb and normally shares its understood subject; an indirect statement contains its own accusative subject. Infinitive tense is relative to the governing verb, not an absolute calendar label.

2.3 Working protocol

Before looking anything up, mark the finite verb or verbal center, propose dictionary forms, and record at least two formally possible readings where an ending is syncretic. Use the identified 1962 Missal and the course source record for received wording. A familiar English rendering does not replace a parse.

Part II

Core Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Infinitives and indirect statement

On completing this unit, you can:

- form all six ordinary infinitives and state their relative time and voice;
- distinguish complementary, subject, object, and indirect-statement infinitives;
- identify the accusative subject and predicate complement of indirect statement;
- preserve relative time when converting direct speech to reported speech.

1.1 The infinitive system

An **infinitive** is a non-finite verbal form: it expresses tense and voice but not grammatical person. Its **relative time** locates its action before, at the same time as, or after the action of its governing verb; the label “present infinitive” therefore means simultaneous, not necessarily present on the calendar. An **indirect statement** reports a thought, perception, or assertion in its ordinary form as an accusative subject plus infinitive rather than quoting it as an independent finite clause.

Forms and relative time

	Present (simultaneous)	Perfect (prior)	Future (subsequent)
Active	<i>amare</i>	<i>amavisse</i>	<i>amaturus, -a, -um esse</i>
Passive	<i>amari</i>	<i>amatus, -a, -um esse</i>	<i>amatum iri</i>

Present passive infinitives are *amari, moneri, regi, capi, audiri*: the first, second, and fourth conjugations replace the active infinitive’s final *-e* with *-i*, while the third and third-*-io* use the present stem without its short vowel plus *-i*. Perfect passive and future active participles agree with their accusative subject in indirect statement: *dicit hostiam oblatam esse; dicit Christum venturum esse*. The future passive *amatum iri* is invariant and rare; ecclesiastical prose often substitutes *fore ut* + subjunctive.

The infinitive tense is relative to the governing verb, not calendar time. Thus *dixit eum venire* means he said the man was coming then; *dixit eum venisse*, that he had come; *dixit eum venturum esse*, that he would come.

Four jobs

1. A **complementary infinitive** completes the meaning of verbs such as *possum, debeo, volo, nolo, incipio*: *possumus orare*.
2. A **subject infinitive** fills the subject slot and acts as a neuter singular noun: *orare bonum est*.
3. Some verbs order or permit an accusative to act: *iube hæc perferri*; the accusative is logical subject of the passive infinitive.
4. Verbs of saying, thinking, knowing, perceiving, and their passives introduce indirect statement: accusative subject + infinitive. A reflexive *se* refers to the reporting subject. Predicate nouns/adjectives are accusative: *scimus Christum Dominum esse*.

1.2 Reading the forms in context

Worked example: simultaneous action in reported thought (Luke 2:44)

Worked passage ID: W.II.9; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Existimantes autem illum esse in comitatu, venerunt iter diei.

Analysis. *Existimantes* introduces indirect statement. Accusative *illum* is subject of present infinitive *esse*; his supposed presence is simultaneous with their thinking. *Iter diei* is an accusative of extent with a genitive measure.

Translation. “Thinking that he was in the company, they traveled a day’s journey.”

Worked example: an ordered passive action in the Canon

Worked passage ID: W.II.10; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Iube hæc perferri per manus sancti Angeli tui in sublime altare tuum.

Analysis. Imperative *iube* takes accusative *hæc* as the subject of present passive infinitive *perferri*. The present infinitive marks action simultaneous with the command, not present clock time.

Translation. “Command these things to be carried by the hands of your holy Angel to your altar on high.”

Worked example: two dependent infinitives before Communion

Worked passage ID: W.II.11; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Fac me tuis semper inhærere mandatis, et a te numquam separari permittas.

Analysis. *Me* is the understood subject of active *inhærere* after *fac*; it is also the understood subject of passive *separari* after *permittas*. *mandatis* is dative with *inhærere*; *a te* marks separation.

Translation. “Make me always cling to your commandments, and never permit me to be separated from you.”

Worked example: predicate accusative (Romans 6:11)

Worked passage ID: W.II.12; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Ita et vos existimate, vos mortuos quidem esse peccato, viventes autem Deo, in Christo Iesu Domino nostro.

Analysis. *Existimate* introduces reported judgment. *vos* is the accusative subject of *esse*; predicate *mortuos* agrees with it. Parallel *viventes* shares the omitted *esse*. Datives *peccato* and *Deo* express relation.

Translation. “So you too, consider yourselves indeed dead to sin but alive to God in Christ Jesus our Lord.”

1.3 Writing laboratory

Copy the six-infinitive grid for *amo*, then reproduce it for *rego* and the deponent *sequor* (present *sequi*, perfect *secutum esse*, future *secuturum esse*). Draw a time line under each tense.

Turn *Christus venit* (present, “comes”) / *venit* (perfect, “came/has come”) / *veniet* (future) into statements after *Sacerdos dicit* and after *Sacerdos dixit*. Compose “We believe Christ to be Lord,” “He said that the offering had been received,” and “Command the gifts to be blessed.” Explicitly mark each accusative subject.

Advance when: you form eighteen prompted infinitives at 90% accuracy, identify subject and relative time in ten unseen infinitive constructions with no more than one error, and convert three direct statements of different times into accurate indirect statement.

Part III

Enrichment by Submodule

CHAPTER 1

Connections, transfer, and retrieval

1.1 The infinitive system — enrichment and transfer

Connection. A two-dimensional voice/time axis prevents form labels from being reduced to one English infinitive.

Transfer task. Place all six lesson infinitives for one regular verb on an active/passive by simultaneous/prior/subsequent grid. Under each, write its morphological components rather than a full translation.

Retrieval check. State the relative time represented by present, perfect, and future infinitives.

1.2 Reading the forms in context — enrichment and transfer

Connection. Complementary and indirect-statement minimal pairs can contain the same infinitive while assigning different subject structure.

Transfer task. Take one infinitive from the lesson and diagram its complementary use beside an indirect statement. Box the governing verb, circle any accusative subject, and draw the understood-subject link where no new subject is expressed.

Retrieval check. Give the decisive structural difference between the two constructions.

1.3 Writing laboratory — enrichment and transfer

Connection. A time axis checks whether conversion to reported speech preserves chronology when the reporting verb changes.

Transfer task. Use the lesson's three direct-time prompts. For each, mark event time relative to reporting time, then convert after a present reporting verb and after a past reporting verb without changing that relation.

Retrieval check. Explain why a perfect infinitive need not refer to an event remote from the speaker's present.

Part IV

Selected Practice

CHAPTER 1

Infinitives and indirect statement: parallel forms

V2.3A — Infinitives A**Worksheet ID:** II.9**Focus:** six infinitives, accusative subject, relative time**Use:** Draw a time arrow from each infinitive to its governing verb.

1. Give all six infinitives of *amo*.

2. Change direct *Christus venit* (he has come) after *Sacerdos dicit*.

3. Translate the time contrast: *dixit eum orare / oravisse / oraturum esse*.

4. Explain agreement in *dicit hostias oblatas esse*.

5. **Text:** *Existimantes autem illum esse in comitatu, venerunt iter diei*.

Passage ID: II.9.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Mark the reported thought and translate.

6. Write in Latin: “We know that Christ is Lord and that he will come.”

Definition/error check: First define uncertain Focus terms from memory; after the work, record each correction’s rule.

V2.3D — Infinitives D**Worksheet ID:** II.12**Focus:** six infinitives, accusative subject, relative time**Use:** Draw a time arrow from each infinitive to its governing verb.

1. Give the infinitive system of deponent *sequor*.

-
2. Report *Nos peccavimus* with a reflexive after *Confitentur*.

-
3. Translate *putabant Christum venturum esse*.

-
4. Explain why *dicit se Dominum esse* can be ambiguous outside context.

-
5. **Text:** *Ita et vos existimate, vos mortuos quidem esse peccato, viventes autem Deo, in Christo Iesu Domino nostro.*

Passage ID: II.12.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Supply the ellipsis and translate.

-
6. Write in Latin: “He ordered the offering to be carried and said that it had been received.”
-

Definition/error check: First define uncertain Focus terms from memory; after the work, record each correction’s rule.

Part V**Mastery Decision****CHAPTER 1**

Mastery and error record

Complete this page before opening the answer part.

Evidence	Session 1	Session 2 / delayed check
Date and elapsed focused time		
Worksheet ID and score		
One rule retrieved without notes		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or delayed item used		

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:**

Reason in one complete sentence:

Part VI

Answer Key

CHAPTER 1

How to Use the Keys

These keys diagnose grammatical decisions. Compare them only after completing the corresponding worksheet or assessment in ink. For a closed item, locate the form, function, government, or clause relation that decides the answer; a matching English paraphrase alone is not enough. For an open task, use the stated model and rubric to test morphology, syntax, idiom, and source control.

Some translations legitimately admit more than one English wording. An alternative is acceptable when it preserves the Latin agency, negation, time, dependency, and material ambiguity. Record a defensible alternative in the error ledger rather than changing it merely to imitate the model's style.

CHAPTER 2

Enrichment models and rubrics

The infinitive system — model and rubric

Connection. A two-dimensional voice/time axis prevents form labels from being reduced to one English infinitive.

Model / acceptable evidence. Present infinitives are ordinarily simultaneous with the governing verb, perfect infinitives prior, and future infinitives subsequent; the active/passive axis separately identifies voice. Every cell must use the formation printed in the lesson.

Reading the forms in context — model and rubric

Connection. Complementary and indirect-statement minimal pairs can contain the same infinitive while assigning different subject structure.

Model / acceptable evidence. A complementary infinitive completes the governing verb and ordinarily shares its subject; indirect statement has an accusative subject belonging to the reported proposition. The presence and role of that accusative, not an English “to” or “that”, decides the analysis.

Writing laboratory — model and rubric

Connection. A time axis checks whether conversion to reported speech preserves chronology when the reporting verb changes.

Model / acceptable evidence. Each conversion must preserve simultaneous, prior, or subsequent relation to its governing report. A perfect infinitive marks priority relative to that report; absolute remoteness is not encoded by the infinitive label alone.

CHAPTER 3

Selected worksheet solutions

CHAPTER 4

Infinitives and indirect statement: parallel forms

V2.3A — Infinitives A

Worksheet ID: II.9

Focus: six infinitives, accusative subject, relative time**Use:** Draw a time arrow from each infinitive to its governing verb.

1. Give all six infinitives of *amo*.
Answer / model: *amare, amari; amavisse, amatum esse; amaturum esse, amatum iri*. Participial forms change to agree with an expressed subject.
2. Change direct *Christus venit* (he has come) after *Sacerdos dicit*.
Answer / model: *Sacerdos dicit Christum venisse*. Accusative *Christum* is subject; perfect *venisse* is prior to present *dicit*.
3. Translate the time contrast: *dixit eum orare / oravisse / oraturum esse*.
Answer / model: “He said that he was praying / had prayed / would pray.” The times are simultaneous, prior, and subsequent to *dixit*.
4. Explain agreement in *dicit hostias oblatas esse*.
Answer / model: *Hostias* is accusative plural subject; perfect passive participle *oblatas* agrees feminine accusative plural; action is prior and passive.
5. **Text:** *Existimantes autem illum esse in comitatu, venerunt iter diei*.
Passage ID: II.9.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Mark the reported thought and translate.
Answer / notes: *Illum* is accusative subject of present infinitive *esse*; the thought is simultaneous with *existimantes*. “Thinking that he was in the company, they traveled a day’s journey.”
6. Write in Latin: “We know that Christ is Lord and that he will come.”
Answer / model: *Scimus Christum Dominum esse et venturum esse*. *Venturum* agrees with *Christum*; repeated *Christum* is unnecessary.

V2.3D — Infinitives D

Worksheet ID: II.12

Focus: six infinitives, accusative subject, relative time**Use:** Draw a time arrow from each infinitive to its governing verb.

1. Give the infinitive system of deponent *sequor*.
Answer / model: Present *sequi*; perfect *secutum, -am, -os, -as, -a esse*; future *secuturum, -am, -os, -as, -a esse*. The participles agree with the accusative subject in every gender and number. All have active meaning; deponents have no separate passive infinitives here.
2. Report *Nos peccavimus* with a reflexive after *Confitentur*.
Answer / model: *Confitentur se peccavisse*. *Se* refers to the plural subject of *confitentur*; infinitive never changes for person.
3. Translate *putabant Christum venturum esse*.
Answer / model: “They thought that Christ would come.” *Christum* is accusative subject; *venturum* future active, subsequent to the thinking.

4. Explain why *dicit se Dominum esse* can be ambiguous outside context.

Answer / model: *Se* refers to the subject of *dicit*, but the identity of that subject must come from context; *Dominum* is predicate accusative.

5. **Text:** *Ita et vos existimate, vos mortuos quidem esse peccato, viventes autem Deo, in Christo Iesu Domino nostro.*

Passage ID: II.12.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Supply the ellipsis and translate.

Answer / notes: The second *vos* is accusative subject of *esse*; *viventes* shares an omitted second *esse*. “So you too, consider yourselves indeed dead to sin but alive to God in Christ Jesus our Lord.”

6. Write in Latin: “He ordered the offering to be carried and said that it had been received.”

Answer / model: *Iussit oblationem perferri et dixit eam acceptam esse.* Both *oblationem* and *eam* are accusative subjects; *acceptam* agrees with *eam*.

Part VII

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-II.3, *Infinitives and Indirect Statement*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative teaching unit, its local reference decisions, enrichment for each internal submodule, the selected worksheets named in the module plan, and the matching solutions. This packet covers the ordinary six-form system and indirect statement; exceptional infinitive constructions remain dictionary- and context-dependent.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. Two focused sessions describe the packet's planned core, while the mastery gate and delayed recall determine advancement.

1.2 Corpus, text, and limits

The controlling reader is the 1962 typical edition of the *Missale Romanum*; the identified Clementine Vulgate and other ecclesiastical prose are supporting corpora. Running Latin normally uses consonantal *i*, the ligature *æ*, and no macrons. Received excerpts may normalize typography but are not diplomatic transcriptions unless labeled. Uncited short drills, transformations, and instructional models are project-composed; English translations and glosses are project translations unless identified otherwise.

This packet teaches language competence. It is not an official liturgical book, approved seminary curriculum, certification, pronunciation or ceremonial course, critical edition, or authority for a liturgical, theological, textual, or canonical judgment. Check received wording against the editions identified in the course-wide passage inventory.

1.3 Review, rights, and release state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and enrichment. No independent Latinist, liturgist, pedagogue, theologian, or ecclesiastical reviewer is claimed. Page-image collation and the donor and liturgical-text distribution bases remain unresolved pre-installation gates. The packet therefore remains a working build on hold, not an installed or released publication.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source

roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.
- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-20T21:32:44Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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